Week 4 In-Class Group Activity Template: Skills Approach Scenarios

Group Number: 19
Course Section:
Date:

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Instructions

- Complete at least five (5) scenarios
- Discuss each question as a group before writing
- Write clear answers that apply the skills approach
- Submit one PDF per group by the end of class

Scenario 1 — Technical Skill

1. Based on technical skill (systems, tools, processes), what is not working properly in this situation?
   Answer: The team's core systems and process, email workflows, task assignment, scheduling, and event-prep procedures, are inconsistent or unclear, causing late communication and disorganized execution.

2. What specific tools, systems, or procedures would a leader need to understand or fix to improve results?
   Answer: clear timelines, deadlines, standard communication tools, expectations, defined roles, and documented procedures

3. Why would trying to "motivate people more" not fix the problem if these technical issues stay the same?
   Answer: Motivation cannot compensate for broken systems; even highly committed people will continue producing inconsistent results if the underlying processes, tools, and structures remain unclear or inefficient.

Scenario 2 — Human Skill

1. What human skills (how the leader works with people) are most important in this situation?
   Answer: The most important human skills are building trust and psychological safety, since one of the members is self-conscious and is unable to express themselves, and communicating clearly and professionally to ensure conversations don't turn into arguments.

2. What should the leader's first conversation focus on before talking about the task or solution?
   Answer: Start by repairing the relationship and clarifying the emotional climate. Acknowledge the tension, validate each person's feelings, and invite each to share their perspective while the leader listens and paraphrases

3. What is one response the leader should avoid because it would make the conflict worse?
   Answer: The leader should avoid blaming certain individuals and instead provide

constructive feedback addressing the problems and work towards solving them as a group.

Scenario 3 — Conceptual Skill

1. Why does this situation require conceptual skill (big-picture thinking) rather than a quick technical fix?
   Answer: This situation requires conceptual skill rather than a quick technical fix because the trade off is uncertain and could result in bigger issues in the long term if problem solving is rushed.
2. What long-term impacts or stakeholders should the leader think about before deciding?
   Answer: They should think about staffing challenges, budget strain, and reputational issues in the future years and decide if the trade off for a short term solution is worth it.
3. Why is this type of thinking especially important for senior leaders?
   Answer: Because their decisions shape the future of the organization. Poor long-term decisions can have wide and lasting consequences

Scenario 4 — Problem-Solving Skills

1. Before jumping to solutions, what should the leader do to clearly define the problem?
   Answer: The leader should let everyone in the group speak their opinion on the problem then work on a solution that is as fair as possible and satisfies the majority.
2. What information would help the leader understand what is really causing the issue?
   Answer: The collective information of all individuals would helpthe leader understand the main problem.
3. What real-world limits (time, money, people, rules) should be considered when developing solutions?
   Answer: consider limits related to time, budget, staff availability, and organizational rules

Scenario 5 — Social Judgment Skills

1. Which social judgment skills would help the leader understand why team members are reacting differently? Name two and explain.
   Answer:
2. Identify two different concerns or perspectives team members might have and explain why they make sense.
   Answer:
3. What is one specific way the leader could adjust how the change is communicated or implemented without changing the goal?
   Answer:

Scenario 6 — Knowledge & Schema

1. How does experience and knowledge help the more experienced leader handle complexity more effectively?
   Answer: Experience gives the leader a larger mental library of past situaitions, allowing them to recongize patterns quickly, filter out irrrelavelnt details, and priotize issues with

less cognitive strain. Thai reduces overwhelm and makes complex environments feel more predictable and manageable.

2. What is a schema, and how does it help leaders make sense of complicated situations?
   Answer: A scheme is a mental framework that organizes knowledge into recognizable patterns. It helps leaders interpret new information fast, spot what matters,s and connect current challenges to familiar structures so decisions become clearer and more accurate

3. Why does having more knowledge usually lead to better decisions over time?
   Answer: Knowledge expands the leader's ability to compare options, anticipate consequences, and avoid repeating past mistakes. With a richer base of understanding, their judgement become more informed, more efficient and more aligned with long-term success.

Scenario 7 — Career Experiences

1. What types of career experiences helped the first leader become more effective in complex situations?
   Answer:

2. How would these experiences help develop big-picture thinking or people skills rather than just technical ability?
   Answer:

3. Why does this example suggest leadership skill develops over time through experience?
   Answer:

Scenario 8 — Environmental Influences

1. What internal organizational factors are making leadership more difficult in this situation?
   Answer:

2. What external factors are affecting outcomes, even if the leader is skilled?
   Answer:

3. Why is it important to consider these factors when judging leadership performance?
   Answer: